

Joseph Melkonian

jmelkonian@g.harvard.edu

EDUCATION

Harvard University

PhD Candidate in Public Policy (Economics Track), G5, ABD

Aug 2021 —

University of California, Davis

B.A. Economics, with Highest Honors

B.A. International Relations, with Honors

Sep 2015 — Jun 2019

3.97 GPA

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

19th ADB-BOK-IDB-Y-RISE(Yale)-Yonsei IPHC International Conference on Migration and Development

Yonsei University

April 2026

- *Shock Propagation through Migrant Networks: Evidence from Subnational Migration in the Spain-Ecuador Migration Corridor*

Seoul, South Korea

European Development in a Historical Perspective – Ph.D. & Postdoctoral Conference

May 8, 2026

Minda de Gunzburg Center for European Studies at Harvard University

- *Emigration by Exodus: Minority Emigration and Economic Development in North African Decolonization* Cambridge, MA

GRANTS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Graduate Student Associate • Weatherhead Center for International Affairs at Harvard University

May 2026 –

- Accepted to the Weatherhead Graduate Student Associates program for the 2026-27 academic year.

Mid-Dissertation Grant • Weatherhead Center for International Affairs at Harvard University

May 2026

- Grant to fund research assistant for project on historical North African minority migration.

Doctoral Fellow • Harvard Mellon Urban Initiative

July 2025 – May 2026

- Participate in the HMUI Doctoral Workshop as a Doctoral Fellow for the 2025-26 academic year.

Urban Research Grants • Harvard Mellon Urban Initiative & Mahindra Humanities Center

Feb & Sep 2025

- Grants to fund a GIS research assistant for research on migration and construction in developing countries.

Research Scholars Program • Harvard Center for International Development

Sep 2024 — May 2025

- Matched with an HKS student research assistant to standardize Arab Barometer surveys for development research.

Foreign Language and Area Studies Grant • Harvard Center for African Studies

April 2022

- Grant to study Moroccan Arabic in Morocco over summer 2022.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant • Malcolm Weiner Center for Social Policy, Harvard Kennedy School

Jun 2023 — Jan 2026

- Conducted labor and housing analyses for Professors Gordon Hanson and Enrico Moretti.

Cambridge, MA

Research Assistant • Evidence for Policy Design & Morocco Employment Lab

Jun 2022 — Aug 2022

- Served as an interim project manager on a team running a nationally representative household survey.

Rabat, Morocco

Research Assistant • Insurance Initiative, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago

Jul 2019 — Jul 2021

- Contributed to policy briefs, chart books, and research projects on the insurance industry.

Chicago, IL

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON 970: Sophomore Tutorial: MENA Migration • Harvard College • Instructor

Spring 2025,'26

ECON 1010A: Intermediate Microeconomics • Harvard College • Teaching Fellow, Head Proctor

Fall 2023,'24,'25

ECON 1123: Intro to Econometrics • Harvard College • Teaching Fellow

Spring 2024

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Graduate Student Workshop in Economic and Social Policy • Harvard Kennedy School

Aug 2023 — May 2024

- Co-coordinated weekly workshops for PhD students to present economics research in social policy.

Cambridge, MA

Graduate Student Workshop in Political Economy & Rational Choice • Harvard University

Aug 2022 — May 2023

- Co-coordinated interdisciplinary workshops for PhD students to present research in political economy.

Cambridge, MA

SKILLS AND OTHER

Programming: STATA (Fluent), R, Python

Languages: English (Native), French (Fluent), Moroccan Arabic (Advanced Intermediate), Modern Standard Arabic (Beginner)

Affiliations: Harvard Center for International Development PhD Affiliate

Citizenship: USA